

Comparing definitions from Strong's, Gesenius, and comparing them to the MT & contextual definitions from the KJV English.

Psalms 22:16
For dogs have compassed me: the assembly of the wicked have inclosed me: they pierced^{H3738 H738} my hands and my feet.

Hebrew Word	Transliteration	Literal Masoretic Meaning	KJV Rendering
כִּי	<i>kî</i>	For / Because	For
סָבְבוּנִי	<i>sěbābûnî</i>	they have surrounded me	have compassed me
כְּלָבִים	<i>kělābîm</i>	dogs	dogs
עֵדָת	<i>‘ădaṭ</i>	assembly/congregation of	the assembly of
מַרְעִים	<i>měřē’îm</i>	evil-doers	the wicked
הִקְיִפוּנִי	<i>hiqqîpûnî</i>	they have enclosed me	have inclosed me
כְּאֶרֶץ	<i>kā’ărî</i>	like a lion	they pierced
יָדַי	<i>yāḏay</i>	my hands	my hands
וּרְגְלִי	<i>wěraġlāy</i>	and my feet	and my feet

This first example is a great starting point for many reasons.

The MT literally reads “like a lion” instead of what we see in the English which is “they pierced”. This is the only place in the entire Bible that you will find H738 translated as something other than a form of “lion”.

Take special note that in the MT itself the Hebrew word(s) for “pierced”, “bore”, or “dig” DO NOT appear. So, where did the KJV translators get the idea that this noun (lion) should instead be translated into a verb? Purportedly, they got it from the same place every one else got it: from the marginal notes of the scribes of the Masorah, ancient manuscripts, and other translations.

The key difference here is in the interpretation and subsequent definitions given.

Gesenius:

1. כּוּר a root of doubtful authority in the verb, but signifying as far as can be gathered from its derivatives, **TO DIG, TO BORE THROUGH**, like the kindred roots קָרַה, אָכַר, קוּר, נָקַר. Compare Arab. כּוּר a digging in the earth, and in the Indo-Germanic languages, Sanser. *khûr*, to cleave, to dig. Hence מִכְאֲרֶה μάχαιρα, a sword, so called from its piercing, executioner, also מְכוּרֶה, a place where metals are dug, hence native place.

Very many interpreters suppose the verb itself to be found in a passage much discussed as relating to the Messiah [see the note], Ps. 22:17, where David, pursued by the soldiers of Saul, says, "Dogs have surrounded me, the assembly of the wicked have inclosed me כִּאֲרֵי יָדִי וְרַגְלֵי." To give my own opinion, I now regard it as the most simple exposition to retain the ordinary signification of the words, and to translate "as lions" they gape upon, or threaten [this would be a strange ellipsis], "my hands and my feet," i. e. they threaten to tear all my members. The form כִּאֲרֵי is ὥς ὁ λέων, i. e. as lions, like Isaiah 38:13; and to threaten, to gape upon, or a similar verb may be understood in this member of the sentence from the foregoing context, by the ordinary figure zeugma.

However, all the ancient interpreters have taken כִּאֲרֵי as a verb, and this may be defended, if we regard it as a participle of Kal, formed in the Chaldee manner (כִּאֲרֵי part. כִּאֲרֵי and plural, for כִּאֲרִים): כִּאֲרֵי for כִּאֲרִים although it would be cause for surprise if we were to find two grammatical forms of such extreme rarity joined in one word (compare Lehrs. 401, 523). If this opinion were adopted, we should render, piercing, digging through, my hands and my feet, that is, my enemies (who are to be understood by the dogs) with their darts and weapons on every side: and there is no need to remark that even these things apply as suitably as possible to David, to whom this psalm is ascribed in the title, and that at least there is no need to understand them of Christ as affixed to the cross.

A verb of piercing in the sense of wounding (compare כּוּר and Arab. قَوَّرَ to perforate, to wound) is most aptly applied to hostile weapons; and hands and feet are used poetically for all the members and the whole body (compare Hesiod. 114). LXX. ὤρουσαν (the verb which they use elsewhere for כָּרַה). Vulg. *foderunt*. Aqu. Symm. in the Hexapla and Jerome (according to the reading *vinxerunt* [which is a mere erratum]) give the word the signification of binding, tying, which is defensible on philological grounds (and this ought not to have been denied by Hengstenberg, *Christologie* d. A. T. i. p. 180 compare Arab. כּוּר to fold round a head-dress, a wreath, a head-dress, but it is much less suitable to the context. — Aquila in his first edition ἤσχυσαν, they disfigured, i. e. they stained with blood, prob. ascribing to the root כּוּר the signification of the Aramean כֶּאֱר. Farther, that כִּאֲרֵי was commonly regarded as a verb is shown by the reading of two MSS. (כִּאֲרוּ) כִּאֲרוּ for כִּאֲרֵי.

- Gesenius has great difficulty with the interpretation for Psalm 22:16 and he assumes it is a mistake and attempts to correct it with a literal only definition.
 - In doing so, he ascribes the events to only David and dismisses any association with Christ on the cross.
 - He then is also forced to reconcile the “hands and feet” part which he says is simply poetically referring to the “whole body”.
 - 1 Peter 1:10-12, 2 Peter 1:21 make it crystal clear that the Holy Ghost is none other than the Spirit of Christ that spoke through the prophets (Acts 2:29,30) which testified beforehand of the sufferings of Christ.

Strong's:

3738. כָּרָה kârâh , kaw-raw'; a prim. root; prop. to dig; fig. to plot; gen. to bore or open:—dig, × make (a banquet), open.
738. אֲרִי ʾārîy , ar-ee'; or (prol.) אֲרִיָּה ʾaryêh , ar-yay'; from 717 (in the sense of violence); a lion:—(young) lion, + pierce [from the marg.].

- The MT reads literally “like a lion” (H738) but Strong's added H3738 to signal to us the same meaning implied by the scribes of the Masorah in their marginal notes: and that is that “lion” here is not used as a noun but instead as a verb.
- Strong's not only agrees with the KJV translators (and the English), but he also doesn't question the authority or interpretation of what could be a very difficult translation without the Holy Ghost.
 - How else could someone know that the marginal note was the key to explaining why this singular instance of the Hebrew word for “lion” was not to be rendered as a noun as it is in every other instance?

Isaiah 7:14
Therefore the Lord himself shall give you a sign; Behold, a virgin^{H5959} shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.

Gesenius:

עַלְמָה f. of the preceding, a girl of marriageable age, like the Arab. **عَلَمَة** and Gr. **νεᾱνίς** (by which word Hebrew is rendered by the LXX. Ps. 68:26 and Aqu., Symm., Theod., Isa. 7:14), Gen. 24:43; Ex. 2:8; Prov. 30:19; Cant. 1:3; 6:8. Used of a youthful spouse recently married, Isa. 7:14 (compare **נְעִרָה** [see note at the end of the art.] **The notion of unspotted virginity is not that which this word conveys, for which the proper word is בְּתוּלָה** [betulah] (compare Cant. 6:8, and Prov. loc. cit.; so that in Isa. loc. cit. the LXX. have incorrectly rendered it *παρθένος*); **neither does it convey the idea of the unmarried state**, as has of late been maintained by Hengstenberg, (Christol. des A. T. ii. 69), **but of the nubile state and puberty**. See Comment. on Isa. loc. cit.—**עַלְעֲלָמוֹת** in the manner of virgins, *nach Jungfrauen Weise* (see No. 1, **ג**, **ג**), i. e. with the virgin voice, sharp, Germ. *soprano*, opp. to the lower voice of men, 1 Ch. 15:20 (see as to this passage under the root **עוּן** No. 1 Piel); Ps. 46:1. Forkel (Gesch. der Musik, i. p. 142) understood it to mean virgin measures (compare Germ. *Jungfrauenweis*), but this does not suit the context, in 1 Ch. loc. Cit.

- According to Gesenius, “virgin” is not the correct translation.
 - That would mean that the KJV translators made a mistake in five places where the Hebrew עַלְמָה “almah” was translated as some form of “virgin”: [Gen 24:43](#), [Pro 30:19](#), [Sos 1:3](#), [6:8](#), [Isa 7:14](#).

Strong's:

5959. עַלְמָה **‘almâh, al-maw’; fem. of 5958; a lass (as veiled or private):—damsel, maid, virgin.**

5958. עֶלֶם **‘elem, eh’-lem; from 5956; prop. something kept out of sight [comp. 5959], i.e. a lad:—young man, stripling.**
עֹלָם **‘ôlâm. See 5769.**

- Strong's definition has no such error in it as does Gesenius'. However, it could appear deceptive if you don't read it carefully or don't know how to read it.
 - First, his definition for *almah* is “a lass” which means simply “a young woman; a girl”. And that is technically correct as even Gesenius noted.
 - What's important is what is lacking: Strong does not question the interpretation or try to explain what only God can: “Why was this translated to virgin when the Hebrew word doesn't convey marital or sexual status?”. He simply gives it to us as it was written.

Psalms 9:17
The wicked shall be turned into hell^{H7585}, and all the nations that forget God.

Gesenius:

שְׁאוֹל f. (once m. Job 26:6; i. q. שְׁאָה Isa. 5:14; 4:9); *orculus*, *hades*, a subterranean place, full of thick darkness (Job 10:21, 22), in which the *shades of the dead* are gathered together (עֲמֻקִּים which see), and to which are attributed both valleys [rather depths] (Pro. 9:18) and gates (Isa. 38:10); Gen. 37:35; Num. 16:30, seqq., Psa. 6:6; Isa. 14:9, seqq., 38:18; Eze. 31:16, seqq., 32:21, seqq. (Syr. נְשִׁיּוֹל f. and Eth. סִיּוֹל : hell, *purgatory*, *limbus Patrum*.) I think that I have lighted on the true etymology of the word. For I have no doubt that שְׁאוֹל is for שַׁעַל a hollow, *a hollow and subterranean place*, just as the Germ. *Hölle* is of the same origin as *Höhle*, and Lat. *cælum* is from the Gr. κοῖλος, *holl*, hollow. It is commonly derived from the idea of asking, from its asking for, demanding all, without distinction; hence *orculus rapax*, Catull. ii. 28, 29.

- Associates Sheol with “orculus/orculus rapax” (latin for the Roman god of the underworld).
- Describes the inhabitants as “shades” (mythological ghosts).
- Defines hell as a hollow, subterranean place.
- His definition might be correct if it wasn’t for the mixing of theologies. And when we look at the language he uses elsewhere it becomes very clear that his theology is that of Roman/Classical/Greek mythology and more importantly that he is *adapting* the MT to his theology instead of the other way around.

Ecc. 6:8, אֶרֶץ חַיִּים “the land of the living,” as opposed to the place or *state of the dead* (Hades), Eze. 26:20; 32:23.

Hell is a “state” and not a literal place where those who reject Christ suffer endless torment.

רָפָא—(ו) i. q. רָפָה *flaccid, feeble, weak*, only in pl. רָפָאִים, i. e. *manes*, *shades* living in Hades, according to the opinions of the ancient Hebrews, void

“shades living in Hades” (shades is from the latin *umbrae* which means “shadow”).

Strong's:

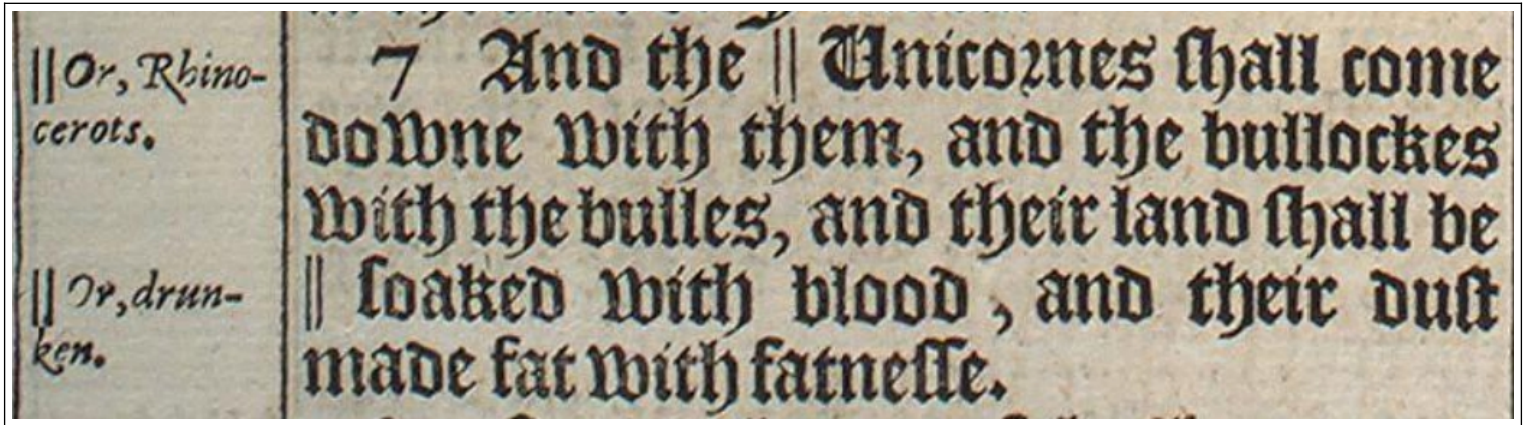
7585. שְׁאוֹל *shē'ôwl, sheh-ole'*; or שְׁאֹל *shē'ôl, sheh-ole'*; from 7592; *hades* or the world of the dead (as if a subterranean *retreat*), includ. its accessories and inmates:—grave, hell, pit.

- Strong's gives us the simple technical definition but there are a few details worth pointing out:
 - He uses the word “world” of the dead ([Hebrews 11:3](#); world^s and “things which are seen”).
 - He uses an appropriate word to describe the conscious inhabitants of hell: *inmates* ([Isaiah 61:1](#), [Luke 4:18,19](#)). Before Christ died on the cross, ALL the dead were *inmates* in hell.

Isaiah 34:7
And the unicorns^{H7214} shall come down with them, and the bullocks with the bulls; and their land shall be soaked with blood, and their dust made fat with fatness.

Hebrew Word	Transliteration	Literal Masoretic Meaning	KJV Rendering
וַיָּרְדּוּ	wə-yā-rə-ḏū	And shall come down	And shall come down
רִאמִּים	rə-ʾê-mîm	unicorns	unicorns
עִמָּם	ʿim-mām	with them	with them,
וּפָרִים	ū-ṗā-rîm	and bullocks	and the bullocks
עִם	ʿim	with	with
אֲבִירִים	ʾab-bî-rîm	bulls	the bulls;
וְנִתְּחָה	wə-rā-wə-tāh	and shall be soaked	and shall be soaked
אֶרְצָם	ʾar-ṣām	their land	their land
מִדָּם	mi-dām	with blood	with blood,
וְעִפְרָם	wa-ʾă-ṗā-rām	and their dust	and their dust
מִחֶלֶב	mê-ḥê-leḇ	from fatness	made fat with fatness.

First edition 1611 Holy Bible:



- In 1611 “Unicorn” (Latin: “unus cornu”/”unicornus” or “one horn”) was the common term for any animal with one horn.
- In 1611 “Rhinocerotus” (Greek: “rhis keras” or “nose horn”) was a scholarly, foreign, technical term. It follows the plural form of the Greek *rhinokerotos* which is now commonly known as simply “Rhinoceros” (see *Rhinoceros unicornis*).
- In the margin the KJV translators left a note that is a deliberate aid for the reader to understand their translation. Refer to the introduction to the readers in the 1611 Holy Bible for more details, in their own words, about why they added these marginal notes.

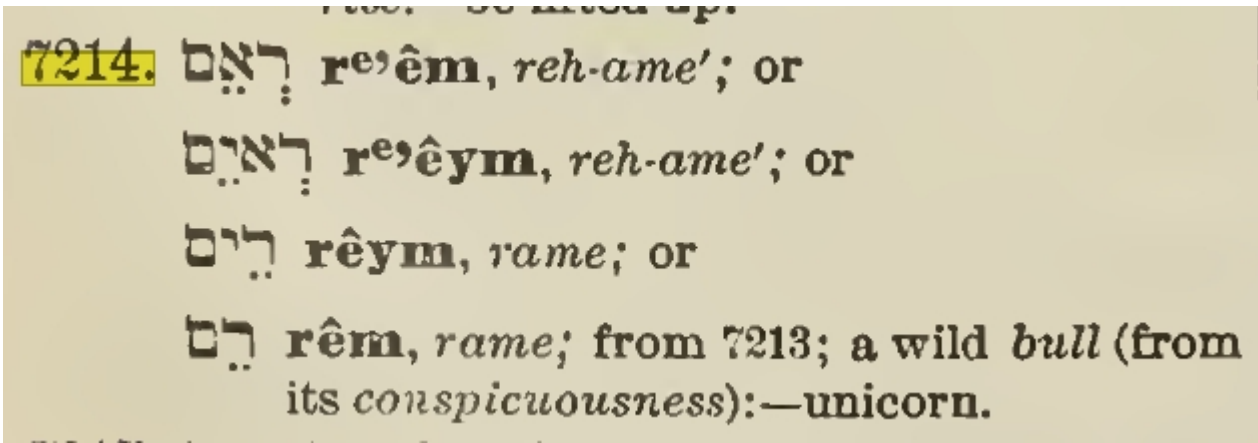
Gesenius:

רִאִם Nu. 23:22; Job 39:9, 10; רִאִים Psa. 92:11; רִים Psa. 29:6; also רִמִּים Psa. 22:22; m. a wild animal, fierce and untamed, resembling an ox, as a wild ass resembles an ass (Job loc. cit. Deut. loc. cit. comp. Isa. 34:7; Ps. 29:6, where the calf is parallel to רִבִּי-רִאִים); possessed of horns, with which it prostrates every thing (Deut.), and injures men (Psalm 22:22 [but this is figurative]). The animal meant is doubtful; I have no hesitation in agreeing with Alb. Schultens, Job loc. cit. and de Wette on Psalm 22:22; in understanding it to be the buffalo. The Arabic word, indeed, which answers to this ريم denotes a large and fierce species of antelope (Oppian. Cyneget. ii. 445), a meaning which has also been assigned to the Hebrew word by Bochart (Hieroz. i. p. 948, seqq.), Rosenmüller and others; but whatever they say, every one must see that it is much more suitable to compare the buffalo with the ox than the antelope; (of these animals there is an excellent collection in the Zoological Museum at Berlin). The usage of the Arabic language, therefore, in this word, as is often the case, resembles the Hebrew without being altogether identical; and the larger antelopes appear to have acquired the name of buffaloes in Arabic, just as they are called in Greek βούβαλος, βουβαλίσ, and just as the Arabs call animals of the deer kind البقر الوحشى wild bulls—LXX. rendered it μονοκέρας, Vulg. unicornis, an animal described by Pliny (H. N. viii.

21) which has been long considered by naturalists (especially since the time of Buffon) as fictitious and fabulous; but English travellers have of late found it in the deserts of Thibet (see Rosenmüller's Morgenland, ii. p. 269 seq.; Quarterly Review, No. 47). But this interpretation cannot be admitted, as the unicorn is more like a horse than an ox, and also is a very rare animal, while the Rêm, as appears from the passages cited, is common enough in Palestine and the neighbouring regions.

- Psalm 22:22 is the incorrect reference (it's Psalm 22:21).
- Regardless, according to Gesenius this Hebrew word means “a buffalo”.
- Additionally, if you read the last section on unicornis carefully, Gesenius believes that the “unicorn” being referenced is the mythological horse creature! “and also is a very rare animal” implies that he believe that they exist!

Strong's:



- Strong's defines "רֵאִים" as “a wild bull” which unfortunately disagrees with the English and therefore is also in error as is Gesenius’ definition.

Bulls and buffalo typically have two horns and if רֵאִים actually meant “buffalo” or “wild bull” the grammar elsewhere like Psalm 91:10 would be incorrect:

Psalms 92:10

But my horn shalt thou exalt like the horn of an unicorn: I shall be anointed with fresh oil.

- Notice that both are singular “horn”.

You won't find the plural “horns” used with the singular “unicorn” in the Holy Bible because, as the name itself and the context of every usage implies, it's a one-horned beast.

The Breakdown of רֵאִים (Re'emim)

1. The Root (רָאָה – Re'em)
 - This is the singular noun. It means “to be lifted up”, “to be exalted”, or “to rise high” (as in Zech 14:10 “lifted up” רָאָה).
2. The Suffix (ים – im)
 - This is the standard Hebrew masculine plural ending (like adding "s" in English).
3. The Meaning:
 - The word literally refers to a high, lifted up, or exalted beast.

Noah Websters 1828:

U'NICORN, n. [L. unicornis; unus, one, and cornu, horn.]

1. an animal with one horn; the monoceros. this name is often applied to the rhinoceros.

2. The sea unicorn is a fish of the whale kind, called narwal, remarkable for a horn growing out at his nose.

3. A fowl.

fossil unicorn, or fossil unicorn's horn, a substance used in medicine, a terrene crustaceous spar.

The etymology of the English word itself is sufficient to define itself via it's composition alone (Latin: “unus cornu”). Therefore this example is particularly puzzling because it's a really hard one to mess up.

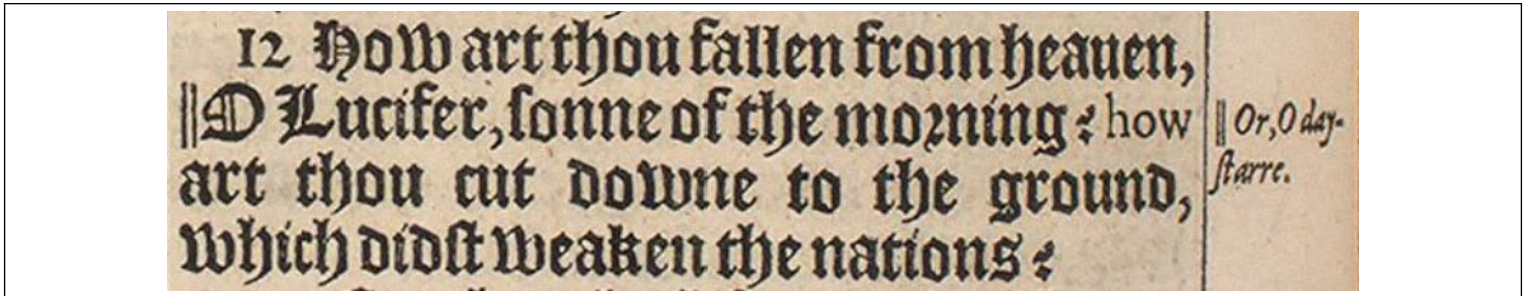
- Monokeros (Greek)
- Unicornus (Latin)
 - Uni – a prefix derived from unus (one)
 - Cornis – derived from cornu (horn)
- Unicorne (Old French)
- Unicorn (Middle English)

Isaiah 14:12
How art thou fallen from heaven, O Lucifer^{H1966}, son of the morning! how art thou cut down to the ground, which didst weaken the nations!

Hebrew Word	Transliteration	Literal Masoretic Meaning	KJV Rendering
אֵךְ	’êk	How	How
נָפַלְתָּ	nā-ṭal-tā	art thou fallen	art thou fallen
מִשָּׁמַיִם	miš-šā-ma-yim	from heaven,	from heaven,
הֵילֵל	hê-lêl	shining one / Lucifer	O Lucifer,
בֶּן-שָׁחַר	ben-šā-ḥar	son of the morning!	son of the morning!
נִגְדַעְתָּ	niḡ-da‘-tā	art thou cut down	art thou cut down
לָאָרֶץ	lā-’ā-reṣ	to the earth,	to the earth,
חֹלַשׁ	ḥō-w-lêš	which didst weaken	which didst weaken
עַל-גּוֹיִם	‘al-gō-w-yim	the nations!	the nations!

Part	Hebrew	Meaning
Prefix/Stem	הִי (Hê)	This indicates the causative or intensive "shining."
Root	יָלַל / הָלַל	To shine / To boast / To cry out.
Full Word	הֵילֵל (Hê-lêl)	The Shining One / The Boaster.

First edition 1611 Holy Bible:



- “Or, day-star”
- Since “day star” is functionally the same as “morning star” (Venus) this marginal note is likely an error (read on to find out why).
 - 2 Peter 1:19, Revelation 22:16
 - Also note that the KJV translator’s “extra-curricular” work was not without error. Refer to the genealogy charts only in the first edition (they were removed after the first edition). The chart beginning with Hezron (page 18). Ahijah (Ahiihah) is depicted as being the wife of Jerahmeel (Ierahmeel) when 1Ch 2:25 clearly lists Ahijah as one of his sons.

night, and perished in one night;" "son of the morning," poetically of the **morning star**, lucifer, as if born in the morning, Isa. 14:12.

הֵיִלֵּל Isa. 14:12 according to LXX., Vulg., Targ. Rabbin. Luth., *stella lucida*, *bright star*, i.e. *Lucifer*
Nor is this a bad rendering, for there is added בֶּן־שָׁחַר and in the Chaldee also Lucifer [the **morning star**], is called בּוֹכֵב נִיְהָה, in Arab. زهرة i.e. splendid star. According to this opinion הֵיִלֵּל would be derived from the root הָלַל to shine; as a participial noun of the conj. קִיטַּל, (comp. Arab. بَيَطِر, Syr. صَبَحَ and the like), or else of a quadriliteral verb הִילֵּל, comp. הִיכֵל, הִיָּדָר. However, הֵיִלֵּל itself is not unfrequently Imper. Hiph. of the verb יָלַל in the signification *wail, lament* (Eze. 21:17; Zec. 11:2), and this does not appear less suitable, and is adopted by Syr., Aqu. and Jerome. ["This is less suitable." Ges. corr.]

- “not a bad rendering” implies that Gesenius thinks there are other renderings that are bad.
- Purely physical as if this is just referring to another star in the sky (Venus).
- Not a single mention of the spiritual side of this text which is that Lucifer is Satan.

Strong's:

1966. הֵיִלֵּל **hēylêl**, hay-lale'; from 1984 (in the sense of brightness); the morning-star:—lucifer.

1984. הָלַל **hâlal**, haw-lal'; a prim. root; to be clear (orig. of sound, but usually of color); to shine; hence to make a show, to boast; and thus to be (clamorously) foolish; to rave; causat. to celebrate; also to stultify:—(make) boast (self), celebrate, commend, (deal, make), fool (-ish, -ly), glory, give [light], be (make, feign self) mad (against), give in marriage, [sing, be worthy of] praise, rage, renowned, shine.

- It looks like Strong also copied the same error. While הֵיִלֵּל does mean to shine, to boast, or to cry out (in the sense of brightness) using “morning-star” for the definition is clearly a very poor choice because it creates an irreconcilable contradiction:

Revelation 22:16
I Jesus have sent mine angel to testify unto you these things in the churches. I am the root and the offspring of David, and the bright and morning star.

Etymological path for the word “lucifer”

1. Latin Roots:
 - *Lux* (genitive *lucis*): meaning "light."
 - *Ferre*: meaning "to bring" or "to bear."
2. Latin Compound: *Lucifer*. In classical Latin, this was an adjective meaning "light-bringing" or "light-bearing." It was also the common name for the morning star (the planet Venus) because it "brought" the light of the morning.
3. The Vulgate (Late 4th Century): St. Jerome used the Latin word *lucifer* in his translation of the Bible (the Vulgate). Most notably, he used it in Isaiah 14:12 to translate the Hebrew word *helel* (meaning "shining one").
4. Old/Middle English: The word was adopted directly from Latin. By the time of Middle English, it was established both as a name for the morning star and as the proper name for the fallen archangel.
5. Authorized King James Version (1611): The KJV translators retained the word Lucifer in Isaiah 14:12, cementing its status in the English language as a proper noun.

Era	Culture	Term Used	Literal Meaning
800 BC	Greek	<i>Phosphoros</i>	Light-bringer
800 BC	Greek	<i>Heosphoros</i>	Dawn-bringer
c. 200 BC	Roman	<i>Lucifer</i>	Light-bringer

Hebrew (Original):

- The Prophet Isaiah used the word *helel* (meaning "shining one").
- Greek (Septuagint): When Hebrew scholars translated the Old Testament into Greek (~250 BC), they used the word *Heosphoros* (Dawn-bringer) to translate *helel*.
- Latin (Vulgate): When Jerome translated the Bible into Latin (~400 AD), he used the common Latin word for "Dawn-bringer," which was *lucifer*.
- English (KJV): The KJV translators chose to keep the Latin word as a proper name in Isaiah 14:12 to distinguish the fallen son of the morning from all other "stars."

Classical Usage: Roman writers like Cicero, Virgil, and Ovid (writing between 100 BC and 50 AD) used the word *lucifer* to describe the planet Venus or the dawn. And so it would appear at first glance that the Latin word *lucifer* came from the Romans but they adopted it from the Greeks.

And so we see as far as the word of God is concerned, *lucifer* never meant “morning star” or “day star” and it never will: because that title belongs to Jesus ([Rev 22:16](#)). And we can also see where in time that “twisting” of the perception of the meaning of the word began: it began with the Greeks and the Romans adopted it.

So, who would want to pretend to be like Jesus? If it isn’t obvious already here’s the answer: [Isaiah 14:14](#) “...**I** will be like the most High” (Satan). The twisting of the perception of the meaning of the word *lucifer* is none other than Satan doing exactly what he said he would do.

To make it even more obvious, let’s look at more of the devil’s work and see what they have to say:

- **New International Version (NIV):** "morning star"
- **English Standard Version (ESV):** "day star"
- **New American Standard Bible (NASB):** "star of the morning"
- **New Revised Standard Version (NRSV):** "Day Star"
- **Holman Christian Standard Bible (HCSB):** "shining morning star"
- **The Living Bible (TLB):** "bright morning star"
- **New Living Translation (NLT):** "bright morning star"
- **Good News Translation (GNT):** "bright morning star"
- **Christian Standard Bible (CSB):** "shining morning star"
- **Revised Standard Version (RSV):** "Day Star"
- **New King James Version (NKJV):** While it keeps "Lucifer" in the text, it often includes a marginal note suggesting "morning star," thereby giving place to the error of the modern critics.

Are you ok with anyone claiming that “Lucifer” is the same as “Jesus”?

Because that’s exactly what Strong’s, Gesenius, someone on the translation committee for the 1611 Holy Bible, and the translators of these mimicries of God’s word are all saying.

Proverbs 18:24
A man that hath friends must shew himself friendly^{H7489}: and there is a friend that sticketh closer than a brother.

Hebrew Word	Transliteration	Grammatical Breakdown	Literal Masoretic Meaning	KJV Rendering
אִישׁ	ʾîš	Noun	A man	A man
רְעִים	rê-ʾîm	Noun (Plural)	of friends	[that] hath friends
לְהִתְרַעֵץ	lə-hiṭ-rô-ʿê-aʿ	Prep. + Verb (Hithpoel)	to be broken / to perish	must shew himself friendly:
וְיֵשׁ	wə-yêš	Conj. + Particle	and there is	and there is
אֶחָב	ʾô-hêḇ	Noun	a friend	a friend
דָּבַק	dā-ḇêq	Verb / Adj.	that sticks	[that] sticketh
מֵאָח	mê-ʾāḥ	Prep. + Noun	than a brother	closer than a brother.

Gesenius:

HITHPOEL הִתְרַעֵץ *to be broken in pieces* (as by a blow), Isa. 24:19; hence *to perish*, Pro. 18:24.
[Derivatives, רָעָה, רָעָה, רָעָה.]

- According to Gesenius Pro 18:24 means that a man that hath friends leads a man “to be broken in pieces” or “to perish”.

Strongs:

7489. רָעָה *râʿaʿ, raw-ahʿ*; a prim. root; prop. to *spoil* (lit. **by breaking to pieces**); fig. to *make* (or *be*) *good for nothing*, i.e. *bad* (phys., soc. or mor.):—afflict, associate selves [*by mistake for* 7462], break (down, in pieces), + displease, (be, bring, do) evil (doer, entreat, man), show self friendly [*by mistake for* 7462], do harm, (do) hurt, (behave self, deal) ill, × indeed, do mischief, punish, still, vex, (do) wicked (doer, -ly), be (deal, do) worse.

- Unfortunately, Strongs definition doesn't get any better.

Neither one agrees with the English and therefore both of them are in error.

Not that any more examples are necessary to prove the point of this study, but I found these interesting so I'll leave them here.

Proverbs 14:23
In all labour there is profit: but the talk of the lips tendeth only to penury^{H4270}.

Strong's:

4270. מַחְסוֹר **machçôwr**, *makh-sore'*; or מַחְסֹר **machçôr**, *makh-sore'*; from 2637; deficiency; hence impoverishment:—lack, need, penury, poor, poverty, want.

This is just a poor definition because the Bible itself defines “penury” as “extreme poverty” and while it isn’t always used that way it leaves Strong’s definition wanting.

Luke 21:4
For all these have of their abundance cast in unto the offerings of God: but she of her penury hath cast in all the living that she had.

This next one is pretty wild and I don’t understand it at all except that it appears to be a snare for the proud.

Proverbs 19:18
Chasten thy son while there is hope, and let not thy soul spare for his crying^{H4191}.

Hebrew Word	Transliteration	Grammatical Breakdown	Literal Strong's/Lexicon Meaning	KJV Rendering
יִסֵּר	yas-sêr	Verb (Piel Imperative)	Chasten / Discipline	Chasten
בִּנְךָ	bin-kā	Noun + Suffix	thy son	thy son
כִּי	kî	Conjunction	for / because	while
יֵשׁ	yêš	Particle	there is	there is
תִּקְוָה	tiq-wāh	Noun	hope	hope,
וְאֶל	wə-'el	Conj. + Prep.	and toward	and
הַמִּיתוֹ	hă-mî-tōw	Verb (Hiphil Inf.) + Suffix	to kill him / to slay him	let not thy soul spare for his crying.
אֶל	'al	Adverb	not	[let] not
תִּשָּׂא	tiś-śā	Verb	lift up / take	[thy soul] spare
נַפְשְׁךָ	naṗ-šê-kā	Noun + Suffix	thy soul	thy soul

Strong's:

4191. מוּת **mûwth**, *mooth*; a prim. root: to die (lit. or fig.); causat. to kill:— × at all, × crying, (be) dead (body, man, one), (put to, worthy of) death, destroy (-er), (cause to, be like to, must) die, kill, necro [-mancer], × must needs, slay, × surely, × very suddenly, × in [no] wise.

While the Hebrew word for “to kill him” or “to slay him” is in the MT, it makes absolutely zero sense if we don’t translate the entire verse exactly as God intended. If we attempt to “fix” this verse by reinterpreting it we inevitably make an error when the English is as clear as it can be.